Deutsche Bank
Research

Rating
Buy

Europe
Germany

Technology
IT Software & Services

Company
SAP

Reuters	Bloomberg	Exchange	Ticker
SAPG.DE	SAP GR	GER	SAPG

Date
24 July 2026

Results

Price at 22 Jul 2026 (EUR)	132.04
Price Target (EUR)	200.00
52-week range (EUR)	254.75 - 132.04

More evidence of 2027 growth acceleration to come – reiterate Buy

Valuation & Risks

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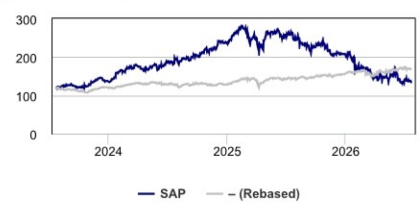
CCB growth surpassing Cloud revenue growth, boding well for '27e group acceleration

SAP had a strong Q2 with the key current Cloud backlog (CCB) KPI growing at a strong 26% y/y cc, above our 25% estimate and Bloomberg consensus at 24%. Even adjusting for some help from M&A (less than 1 pp contribution), y/y cc CCB growth improved slightly vs Q1 and now stands above both Q2 Cloud revenue growth but also the mid-point of FY26e cc Cloud growth guidance. This supports our view that both Cloud revenue and group cc growth should accelerate in FY27e (group to ~12% cc from ~10.5% this year). Combined with strong initial customer momentum on the new AI offering launched at Sapphire (see our note here), pricing discussions for AI solutions in line with expectations and pricing dynamics for the "traditional" SaaS business as robust as ever, according to management, we have yet to see any tangible signs of the AI disruption to SAP's business model that is already priced into the shares. We retain our view that SAP is well on track to make its AI solutions portfolio an incremental growth driver medium-term and see the current valuation levels as highly compelling (7% FCF yield) in the light of a likely growth acceleration next year. Such an acceleration should help improve investor sentiment towards the name – similarly to the Cloud transition a few years ago when re-accelerating group growth marked the turning point for the stock.

Q2 and FY26e profitability slightly burdened by R&D, S&M investments into new AI offering as well as acquisitions but expect profitability momentum to improve from here

While results were good across the board, including FCF which beat our estimate, operating profit came in slightly below for the first time in a while. SAP has chosen to invest more into headcount but also R&D (incl. AI tokens for models) and S&M for its new AI offering launched at Sapphire in May. While these investments could have been digested in the FY26 operating profit guidance, the already announced acquisitions (Reltio, Dremio, Prior Labs - all in investment mode currently) led SAP to marginally lower its profitability outlook for the year. We believe these investments and acquisitions are the right strategic decisions to position the company strongly in AI and take comfort in a likely improvement in profit growth into H2 as the focus returns to operational efficiency across e.g. hiring, travel costs, AI token usage (with strict monitoring tools in place to maximize efficiency) and other factors. Overall, we see SAP on track to deliver continued strong growth, supported by AI innovation and revenues, while retaining a decent operating leverage and remaining within the 80-90% cost growth as a percentage of revenue growth framework provided a while ago going forward.

Price/price relative



Performance (%)	1m	3m	12m
Absolute	-0.1	-11.9	-49.1
DJ (.STOXXE)	-0.5	5.9	19.1

Source: Deutsche Bank

Forecasts and ratios

Year End Dec 31	2024A	2025A	2026E	2027E	2028E
Revenue (EURm)	34,176	36,801	40,203	45,188	50,922
DB EPS (EUR)	4.48	6.10	7.19	8.37	9.94
DB EPS growth (%)	7.5	36.2	17.9	16.5	18.8
P/E (DB EPS) (x)	41.9	39.9	18.4	15.8	13.3

Source: Deutsche Bank estimates, company data

Q2 results in detail

SAP reported Q2 revenues of E9,878m with growth remaining robust at 11% cc y/y (versus 12% in Q1/26 and 9% in Q4/25). Cloud revenues were up 24% cc to E6,281m, slightly above our expectations going into the quarter. Growth continues to be primarily fueled by the ongoing momentum in Cloud ERP Suite (up 27% cc to E5.53b from 30% cc in Q1/26 and Q4/25), encompassing SAP S/4HANA Cloud ERP, SAP BTP, and core solutions for HR and payroll, spend management, commerce, customer data solutions, business process transformation, and working capital management. Growth for the remaining SaaS and PaaS solutions (Extension Suite) remained more solid at 12% cc growth (from 12% in Q1/26 and 10% in Q4/25). Licensing revenue declined 32% y/y cc (to E131m), slightly weaker than our forecast, and Support revenue declined by 7% cc (to E2,439m), slightly better than we had expected. Services declined marginally by 2% cc to E1,027m, with SAP reallocating consultants to build agent extensions and foster AI adoption.

Margins remained strong, with non-IFRS Cloud gross margins reaching 74.6%, down 60bps y/y slightly below DBe and driven by one-offs related to the new platform/Joule Work and increased costs for sovereignty environments. Overall gross margin at 73.4% was stable and in line with DBe. Non-IFRS operating profit (incl. SBC costs) amounted to E2,743 (+9% cc y/y) with margins of 27.8%, below our E2,858m estimate, reflecting dilution from some acquisitions, as well as higher R&D (+14%, related to the hiring of high profile talent and token spending) and S&M spend (+7%, related to the launch of the Autonomous Suite offerings), as well as investments in internal AI adoption. FCF came in slightly above our estimate at E3,002m (+27%).

Guidance marginally updated: new operating profit range now reflects M&A

SAP confirmed its outlook for FY26 largely, but updated the non-IFRS operating profit guidance to reflect >E100m dilution from the recently closed Dremio and Prior Labs acquisition (while dilution from Reltio is being offset). Apart from that, SAP continues to see cc total revenue growth in 2026 at similar levels as in 2025 and to accelerate in 2027. Service revenue is expected to stabilize in FY27. Support revenue (cc) is expected to accelerate the decline in the coming years as a consequence of an acceleration in cloud migrations. Cloud & Software revenues are seen at E36.3-36.8b cc (+12-13% y/y cc), while Cloud revenue is expected to reach E25.8-26.2b at constant currencies (+23-25% y/y cc). For FCF, the company plans ~E10b on the back of positive working capital mechanics (including transformation incentives), as well as further operational improvements and less cash outflows related to SBC.

CCB is still expected to see a slight decline throughout FY26 but significantly less than the ~4pp seen in FY25 which we see at ~23% exit rate this year from ~26% now. With the strong H1, there now is some wiggle room in the context of the macro environment. Management stated the guidance is based on the assumption of a near-term de-escalation of the conflict in the Middle East while it noted some impact from the war on bookings activity already which has been absorbed by other areas performing well.

We will review our model and financial forecasts in more detail in due course but would not expect a significant change to our estimates at this stage. We reiterate our Buy rating and leave our valuation unchanged at ~20x FY27e EV/uFCF, a slight premium to a broad global Software peer group, considering SAP's above peer growth and rapidly evolving AI strategy.

Conference call feedback - Strong customer interest in new AI offering supports deal momentum, offsetting macro headwinds

SAP hosted a confident conference call after US market close yesterday followed by a sell-side analyst call with our key takeaways being:

- The growing partner ecosystem performed exceptionally well, with indirect channel order entry significantly outpacing direct channels, reflecting SAP ´s GTM transformation over the last two years.
- Beta programs for the new Autonomous Suite platform, and Joule Work were oversubscribed after launch at Sapphire with excellent initial customer feedback. Close to 50 assistants and over 400 autonomous suite agents will be released by year-end. ERP migration assistants (3 additional, 10 underlying agents) are also being released to accelerate customer journeys.
- Management noted strong uptake of AI ERP migration toolchain (30% lower costs, faster time to value). Key RISE wins announced included Shell, Morgan Stanley, Samsonite, Vonovia, and Eli Lilly.
- SAP is transforming its own operations (engineering, GMT, consulting AI factory with 3,000 consultants,...) to become an Autonomous Enterprise itself. Focus lies on accelerating innovation (agent delivery <3 weeks, 30% developer productivity increase). Significant investment in AI talent and up/ re-skilling (>90% of employees to be reached) are partly reflected in the slightly lower margin in Q2.
- SAP has not seen any impact from AI on pricing of its SaaS offering, with SAP´s pricing power remaining robust.
- The recent acquisitions of Reltio, Dremio, and Prior Labs have a minor impact on FY26 CCB and Cloud revenue, combined less than one percentage point.
- Headcount grew slightly to 112k (from 109k in the prior year Q2) but management expects no further increase in headcount in the next 12 months, as AI productivity (average 30% gain) kicks in. Focus will be on getting a few experts for AI and driving productivity up.

Appendix 1

Important Disclosures

*Other information available upon request

Disclosure checklist

Company	Ticker	Recent price*	Disclosure
SAP	SAPG.DE	128.32 (EUR) 23 Jul 2026	1, 2, 7, 8, 11, 14, 15, 24, 26

*Prices are current as of the end of the previous trading session unless otherwise indicated and are sourced from local exchanges via Reuters, Bloomberg and other vendors . Other information is sourced from Deutsche Bank, subject companies, and other sources. For disclosures pertaining to recommendations or estimates made on securities other than the primary subject of this research, please see the most recently published company report or visit our global disclosure look-up page on our website at https://research.db.com/Research/Disclosures/EquityResearchDisclosures. Aside from within this report, important risk and conflict disclosures can also be found at https://research.db.com/Research/Disclosures/Disclaimer. Investors are strongly encouraged to review this information before investing.

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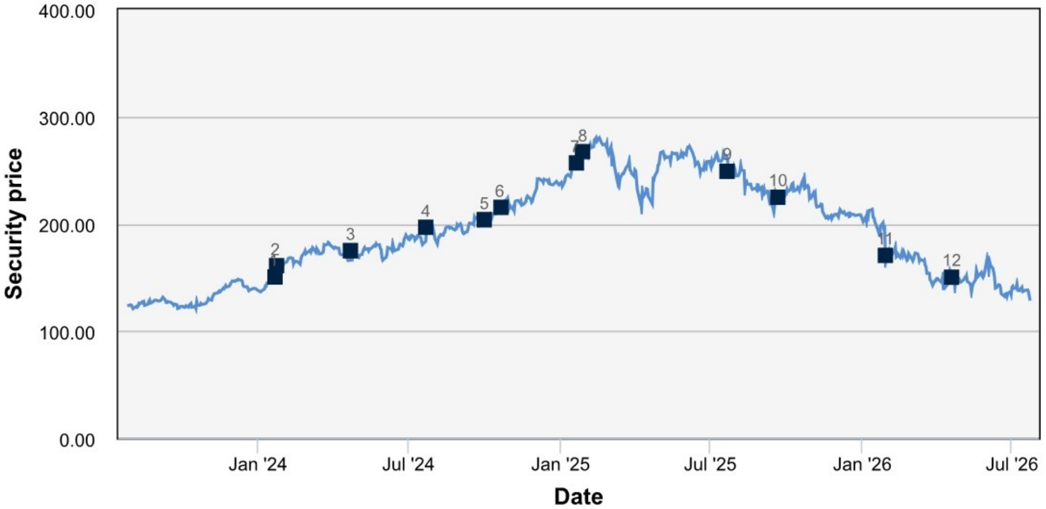
Historical recommendations and target price: SAP (SAPG.DE)

(as of 07/23/2026)



Current Recommendations

Buy
Hold
Sell
Not Rated
Suspended Rating

** Analyst is no longer at Deutsche Bank

1.	01/22/2024	Buy, Target Price Change EUR 170.00, Current Price EUR 150.34 Johannes Schaller
2.	01/24/2024	Buy, Target Price Change EUR 200.00, Current Price EUR 160.76 Johannes Schaller
3.	04/23/2024	Buy, Target Price Change EUR 208.00, Current Price EUR 174.86 Johannes Schaller
4.	07/23/2024	Buy, Target Price Change EUR 215.00, Current Price EUR 196.74 Johannes Schaller
5.	10/02/2024	Buy, Target Price Change EUR 230.00, Current Price EUR 203.75 Johannes Schaller
6.	10/22/2024	Buy, Target Price Change EUR 240.00, Current Price EUR 215.25 Johannes Schaller
7.	01/21/2025	Buy, Target Price Change EUR 300.00, Current Price EUR 256.75 Johannes Schaller
8.	01/29/2025	Buy, Target Price Change EUR 310.00, Current Price EUR 267.20 Johannes Schaller
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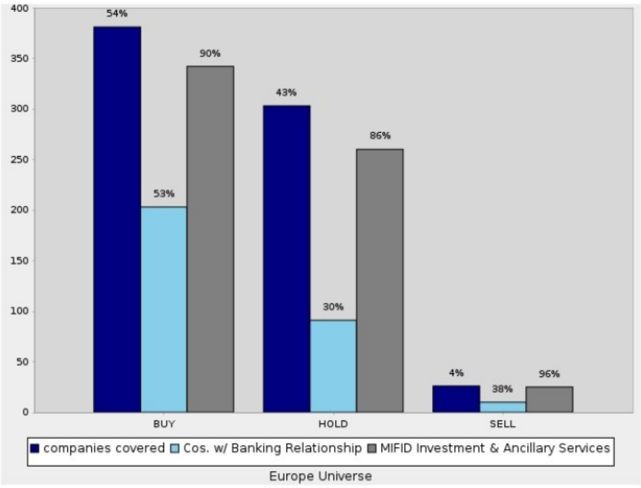
11.	01/30/2026	Buy, Target Price Change EUR 220.00, Current Price EUR 170.56 Johannes Schaller
12.	04/20/2026	Buy, Target Price Change EUR 200.00, Current Price EUR 150.20 Johannes Schaller

Equity rating dispersion and banking relationships



Equity Rating and Dispersion Key

The Equity Rating Dispersion Chart depicts the following:

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